



Construction Manager

construction-manager • Field path (typically 8-12 years)

\$70K-\$100K / yr

THE TRADE

Oversee budgets, schedules, crews, and safety from planning through closeout. Most construction managers rise from the trades — field experience plus leadership training lands you at the top of the board's salary range, and many break six figures.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$70K-\$100K

Site band (trades page / quiz) • usually 8-12 yr field path • no dedicated salary post yet — assumed

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 30 Hour — the leadership standard

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Pick a base trade and start in the field
- ☐ Earn OSHA 10 now, OSHA 30 later
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Look for helper roles that show initiative
- ☐ Learn to read blueprints and specs
- ☐ Study scheduling basics (CPM/Gantt)
- ☐ Practice site math and takeoffs daily
- ☐ Ask GCs how superintendents start
- ☐ Apply to an assistant or apprenticeship
- ☐ Document every project you touch
- ☐ Map a 5-year path to assistant PM

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>